



THE UNIVERSITY OF
MELBOURNE

CURRENT STUDENTS IA · CAREERS & WIL

Careers, employability & WIL

The University's careers offer across the whole estate and lifecycle — and how fragmented it has become. June 2026.

University of Melbourne · June 2026

The University of Melbourne acknowledges the Traditional Owners of the unceded land on which we work, learn and live, and pays respect to their Elders, past and present, and to Indigenous Australians today.

The University’s careers offer, traced across the whole estate and the whole lifecycle — prospective “career outcomes” → the central Careers service → faculty careers → work-integrated learning → graduate outcomes → alumni mentoring. Careers is the most cross-cutting student service there is; this is how fragmented it has become. June 2026.

Executive summary

Careers is the service that should bind the student lifecycle together — it is the through-line from “why this degree?” to “here is my first job” to “now mentor the next cohort.” The University authors a great deal of it: **1,058 careers and employability pages across 18 domains**, plus 92 work-integrated-learning pages. But it is **authored everywhere and connected nowhere**. The central Careers *service* is hollow — ~42 pages of advice on the hub — while the substance sprawls across a 440-page prospective persuasion layer and 539 pages of faculty careers content, and the **actual service** (the jobs board, employer connections and appointment booking on Careers Online) sits behind a login wall reached by just 73 contextual links estate-wide. The public estate describes careers; it almost never lets a student *do* careers.

Three gaps compound this. **Work-integrated learning has no centre at all** — 4 hub pages against 87 on the faculties — so a student cannot discover a placement from anywhere but their own faculty silo. **Faculty mentoring and alumni mentoring are the same service for adjacent life stages, and never link** — a final-year student’s faculty mentoring and the twelve alumni mentoring streams they graduate into do not cross-reference (alumni gets ~97 contextual links total, 0 from any completion page). And the **prospective “career outcomes”** sold to applicants (440 per-course pages) are wired to nothing that delivers them once the student enrolls.

The prize is unusually clean: careers is one service with one obvious owner. Make the hub the front door, surface Careers Online as the action, build the missing WIL centre, and bridge faculty→alumni mentoring — and the most fragmented service becomes the connective tissue the whole lifecycle is missing.

The careers spine across the lifecycle

Stage	Where it lives	Footprint	Note
Prospective — “career outcomes”	<code>study.unimelb</code>	440 pages	per-course career-outcomes tabs — a persuasion layer, separate from the service
Central Careers service	<code>students.unimelb/careers</code>	42 pages	the hub careers section — thin
Careers Online (the action)	<code>careersonline.unimelb</code> • behind login	~115 links in	jobs board + appointments — the actual service, barely pointed to
Faculty careers	8+ faculties	539 pages	fbe 100, arts 84, mbs 72, eng 64, education 54, law 40...
WIL / placements	faculty-owned	92 pages • 4 central	no central front door — undiscoverable from the centre
Alumni mentoring	<code>www.unimelb/alumni</code>	16 pages • 12 streams	the same mentoring service, severed from faculty careers

The spine exists at every stage but the joins are thin: ~115 contextual links reach the careers platforms, WIL has 4 central pages, and the alumni mentoring end is severed (0 links from completion pages).

The findings

Careers is authored everywhere and connected nowhere [HIGH]

Evidence. 1,058 careers/employability pages span 18 domains — but only ~115 contextual links reach the careers platforms (careersonline 73, careers.unimelb 27, career-checklist 13). Several faculties send near-zero contextual links into the central careers service. The lifecycle’s most cross-cutting service is its least connected.

Recommendation. Name one canonical Careers owner spanning the lifecycle and make every careers page (prospective, faculty, alumni) deep-link the central service + Careers Online. Treat careers as connective tissue, not a per-site feature.

The central Careers service is hollow — the action is behind login [HIGH]

Evidence. students.unimelb/careers is ~42 pages of advice, while the actual service — the jobs board, employer connections and appointment booking — lives on careersonline.unimelb.edu.au behind a login wall, reached by only 73 contextual links estate-wide. The public estate describes careers; it never lets the student DO careers.

Recommendation. Make the hub the unambiguous front door that prominently and consistently deep-links Careers Online (and the appointment booking) from every careers and faculty page — surface the action, don't just describe it.

WIL & placements has no central front door [HIGH]

Evidence. Work-integrated learning is 92 pages across 11 faculty domains (fbe 25, medicine 19, education 17, MBS 7...) but only 4 pages on the central hub. A student cannot discover their own or another faculty's placement/WIL offerings from the centre; MDHS clinical-placement compliance and the SONIA placement system are siloed.

Recommendation. Create a single central 'Work-Integrated Learning & Placements' landing that explains WIL in one shared vocabulary and aggregates/deep-links every faculty's offering — the missing centre of this service.

Faculty and alumni mentoring are the same service, never linked [HIGH]

Evidence. Alumni runs 16 mentoring pages across 12 faculty-specific streams (accounting, arts, business, education, engineering, law, MDHS, science, vet science...), and faculties run their own student-mentoring — the same service for adjacent life stages. A final-year student's faculty mentoring and the alumni mentoring they graduate into do not cross-reference. The alumni estate gets ~97 contextual links total and 0 from any completion page.

Recommendation. Bridge faculty student-mentoring to the alumni mentoring streams at the final-year/graduation moment — the highest-value, lowest-cost careers connection across the lifecycle.

FBE and MBS double-host the entire BCom careers tree [HIGH]

Evidence. Two faculties maintain near-identical copies of the same Bachelor of Commerce careers estate — ~59 near-duplicate pages (confirmed by the shingle-Jaccard near-duplicate detector) — so the same careers content is authored, maintained and drifts out of sync twice.

Recommendation. Pick one owner for the BCom careers content and 301-redirect the duplicate tree; the other links it rather than re-hosting.

'Employability in X' is a seven-faculty template clone [MEDIUM]

Evidence. Seven faculties each run a near-identical 'Employability in ' page that restates the same central careers service with a discipline label — template duplication, not discipline-specific value.

Recommendation. One shared central employability page; each faculty contributes only its genuinely discipline-specific layer (regulated pathways, internship subjects, professional registration) and links the centre for the rest.

Prospective 'career outcomes' is a marketing layer disconnected from the service [MEDIUM]

Evidence. study.unimelb carries 440 per-course 'career outcomes' pages (the persuasion that sells the degree), but they are separate from the 42-page current Careers service — the promise made to the applicant is never wired to the service that would deliver it once enrolled.

Recommendation. Connect the prospective career-outcomes promise to the current Careers service and Careers Online, so the outcome a student was sold becomes a service they can use.

No shared careers vocabulary or owner across the lifecycle [MEDIUM]

Evidence. Careers, employability, WIL, placements, internships, mentoring and graduate-outcomes are named and located differently at every stage and on every faculty site — there is no single careers taxonomy a student (or a search) can rely on across prospective → current → alumni.

Recommendation. Define one careers service taxonomy and front door used identically across the lifecycle; standardise the labels (Careers, WIL, Mentoring) and the entry path on every faculty site.

Source: `analysis/full-scrape/careers-pages.csv` (the careers/WIL footprint), the careers + placements service profiles in `analysis/student-services-profiles.json`, the careers spine in `analysis/lifecycle-cross-corpus.md`, and the near-duplicate detector. Careers Online and the placement systems (SONIA) are behind login and uncrawled — inferred from outbound links.